

SECTOR
HEALTH CARE

CLIENT
**Global Market
Research
Company**

GEOGRAPHIES
COVERED
CANADA

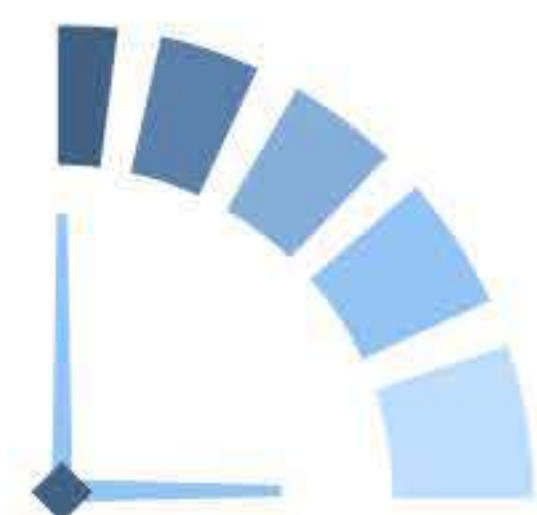


STUDY BACKGROUND

This study aimed to explore the preferences and opinions of dietitians and nutritionists regarding the use of thickeners for patients with dysphagia, a condition that affects swallowing.

The data was collected from 225 dietitians and nutritionists who worked in community, hospital, and long-term care setting across Canada from Ontario, Quebec, British Columbia, Prairie and Atlantic areas. They took part in a 5-minute telephone or online survey.

The survey was hosted internally by the organization and was programmed in both French and English. The data analysis involved cleaning, labelling and tabulating the responses collected by the specialized data collection team.



TIMELINE

Programming/Layover/Hosting – 1 to 2 Business days,
Fielding – 22 business days,
Data Cleaning and Labeling – 1 Business day,
Tabulations – 1 Business day.

BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

Our business objective is to maximize our profits by delivering high-quality research services to our clients. To achieve this, we have the following sub-objectives:

- Control our operational costs by using efficient and reliable methods and tools for data collection and analysis.
- Maintain our project management fees and cost per interview at competitive and reasonable levels, while ensuring that we meet the expectations and requirements of our clients.
- Manage our cash flow effectively by securing timely payments from our clients and paying our respondents promptly for their participation and referral.
- Increase our market share and revenue by attracting and retaining more respondents for our surveys, which depend on the quality of our surveys, the incentives we offer, and the reputation we build.

RESEARCH OBJECTIVE

The objective of this research is to find out how familiar and frequently used different kinds of thickeners are among dietitians and nutritionists who treat patients with dysphagia. Thickeners are frequently given to change the texture of drinks and foods to promote safe swallowing because dysphagia is a swallowing difficulty that can result in serious complications like aspiration and malnutrition. In order to improve the health and quality of life of patients with dysphagia, this survey aims to comprehend the factors that influence the choice of thickeners and how they might be optimized.

SAMPLE SIZE

225 Dieticians and Nutritionists



TARGET CRITERIA

The survey targeted Dieticians and Nutritionists working in community, hospital and long-term settings across five regions: Ontario, Quebec, British Columbia, Prairie and Atlantic.

METHODOLOGY ADOPTED

Our Research Team carried out this research study over 22 business days from 26th April 2023 – Soft launch, 28th April 2023 – Full launch to 25th May 2023 – Fielding close. The methods we used for this project were:

- 1. Online sampling
- 2. Computer-assisted telephone interviewing (CATI)
- 3. Phone-To-Web Recruitment

We obtained about 59% of the samples online and 41% through direct phone interviews conducted by our skilled CATI professionals. The Phone-To-Web recruitment team offered an incentive to respondents to encourage them to join the research survey after the recruitment call and complete it on their own. We believe that incentives are important to match the task and reward the respondents for their time and participation in the online part of the study.

OPERATIONAL CHALLENGES

Meeting the Dieticians quota, which required us to contact a very limited target group of respondents, was one of the biggest hurdles we faced. Given the small number of dieticians who were relevant for the study, this was not a simple process.

Another difficulty was the rarity of dysphagia, which prevented many dieticians from seeing any patients who had it or offering any advice to them in the previous three months. This significantly diminished the number of qualified respondents and made it challenging to locate respondents who met the study's criteria.

OUR APPROACH TO CHALLENGES FACED

- We applied a number of strategies to improve the response rate and the calibre of the data in order to overcome this difficulty.
- We encouraged potential respondents to take part in the survey at any time of the day by sending them personalized emails and routine reminders.
- By asking them for referrals of other dieticians who could be interested in the study, we also took use of the networks of our panelists and those who participated who had previously finished the survey.
- In order to meet with the respondents personally and prevent any communication breakdowns or delays, we also scheduled appointments with them.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This study looked at the preferences and opinions of dieticians and nutritionists regarding the use of thickeners for patients with dysphagia, a condition that affects swallowing. The data was collected from 225 respondents across five regions in Canada using online and phone surveys. The objective was to find out how familiar and frequently used different kinds of thickeners are among the target group.

The main challenge was the low availability and awareness of dysphagia among the respondents, which required us to use various strategies to increase the response rate and the quality of the data. The study was conducted over 22 business days using efficient and reliable methods and tools for data collection and analysis. The results of this study will help us to achieve our business objective of maximizing our profits by delivering high-quality research services to our clients.

SERVICES OFFERED BY MARKELYTICS

Programming/Layover/Hosting, data collection, data cleaning and labelling, and tabulations were among the services made available to the client.

CLIENT FEEDBACK

When the study was officially closed, the client gave a positive email response.